

FILM REVIEWS

evil, symbolised by the monkey man, resides in all of us, but Mehra manages. The film is a series of incidents, underlining each of the isms that plagues India today, and becomes heavy handed only in a silly climax. With street scenes that don't smell of fresh paint, performances that are not plastic and dialogues bordering on poetry, this is a movie that is as civilised in its execution as in its intent. Bollywood movies usually focus on the parivar, both happy and dysfunctional. Rarely do they tell the story of a community, trying to live and love in a time of despair.

by Kaveree Bamzai

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

KAPOOR AND
BACHCHAN



PINKI (CENTRE)
WITH MYLAN

SMILE PINKI

Can and Able

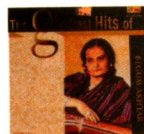
Director: Megan Mylan

This is the season for choking up when seeing our children in peril. It happened with the movie that swept the Oscars, *Slumdog Millionaire*, whose amazing children, Azharuddin, Rubina and Ayush, have shown what innate dignity is all about. There was another such child, living on the margins, rejected by her peers and shamed by herself. *Smile Pinki*, which won the Best Documentary Short Subject, features Pinki, a five-year-old from a village in Uttar Pradesh, who is one of the beneficiaries of the free cleft palate surgeries performed by the NGO Smile Train. But the real star of the film is Ghutaru, whose wordless agony at being laughed at by his friends, can bring tears to the most hardened heart. Impoverished parents hoping to give their children the best in life, doctors not losing their humanity despite doing hundreds of such surgeries, children teetering on the edge of promise and fear. The movie captures it all, not without humour. My Oscar goes to Pinki and Ghutaru.

-KB

MUSIC REVIEWS

Beats of Time



THE GREATEST HITS
OF BEGUM AKHTAR
Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 295

There is a mystical element about Begum Akhtar. Her approach to music was natural and spontaneous. Her sonorous rasaladen voice had a nasal twang and was intensely mischievous. It was the pathos of one who dared to love, lose and suffer. The album opens with all-time ghazal *Aye Mohabbat* followed by thumris, dadras like *Hamar kahin mano rajaji*. Truly a collector's item.



PREM JOSHUA &
BAND IN CONCERT
Music Today
Rs 299

Prem Joshua's international band, formed recently, stands out as one of the most refreshing multicultural experiences to be found between Mumbai and Berlin. The group presents the highlights of their 2007 concert tour in the album—recordings feature seven new versions of the group's classics and two new tracks. His style has a distinct freshness in terms of sound. The rich music, a fusion of various instruments, permeates the senses, infiltrating them with a soulful confluence.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit